

A

In questions we usually put the subject after the first verb:

subject + verb			verb + subject	
Tom	will	→	will	Tom?
you	have	→	have	you?
the house	was	→	was	the house?

- ☐ **Will Tom** be here tomorrow?
- ☐ **Have you** been working hard?
- ☐ When **was the house** built?

Remember that the subject comes after the *first* verb:

- ☐ Is Katherine working today? (*not* Is working Katherine)

B

In *present simple* questions, we use **do/does**:

you	live	→	do	you live ?
the film	starts	→	does	the film start ?

- ☐ Do you **live** near here?
- ☐ What time **does** the film **start**?

In *past simple* questions, we use **did**:

you	sold	→	did	you sell ?
the train	stopped	→	did	the train stop ?

- ☐ Did you **sell** your car?
- ☐ Why **did** the train **stop**?

But do not use **do/does/did** if **who/what** etc. is the subject of the sentence. Compare:

The diagram illustrates the transformation of the sentence "Emma phoned somebody." into its passive form "Who phoned Emma?".

Active Voice: Emma phoned somebody.

- who object:** A bracket connects the word "who" to the object "somebody".
- subject:** A bracket connects the word "subject" to the subject "Emma".

Passive Voice: Who phoned Emma?

- who subject:** A bracket connects the word "who" to the subject "Who".
- object:** A bracket connects the word "object" to the object "Emma".

In these examples, **who/what** etc. is the subject:

- ☐ **Who wants** something to eat? (*not Who does want*)
- ☐ **What happened** to you last night? (*not What did happen*)
- ☐ **How many people came** to the meeting? (*not did come*)
- ☐ **Which bus goes** to the centre? (*not does go*)

C

Note the position of prepositions in questions beginning **Who/What/Which/Where ...** ?:

- ☐ **Who** do you want to speak **to**?
☐ **Which** job has Tina applied **for**?

You can use *preposition* + **whom** in formal style:

- ☐ **To whom** do you wish to speak?

D

Isn't it ... ? / Didn't you ... ? etc. (negative questions)

We use negative questions especially to show surprise:

- ☐ **Didn't you** hear the doorbell? I rang it three times.

or when we expect the listener to agree with us:

- 'Haven't we met before?' 'Yes, I think we have.'

Note the meaning of **yes** and **no** in answers to negative questions:

- ☐ **Don't you** want to go? { Yes. (= Yes, I want to go)
No. (= No, I don't want to go)

Note the word order in negative questions beginning **Why ... ?**:

- ☐ **Why don't we** eat out tonight? (*not* Why we don't eat)
- ☐ **Why wasn't Emma** at work yesterday? (*not* Why Emma wasn't)

Exercises

Unit
49

49.1 Ask Joe questions. (Look at his answers before you write the questions.)

- 1 (where / live?) Where do you live?
- 2 (born there?)
- 3 (married?)
- 4 (how long / married?)
- 5 (children?)
- 6 (how old / they?)
- 7 (what / do?)
- 8 (what / wife / do?)

In Manchester.
No, I was born in London.
Yes.
17 years.

Yes, two boys.

12 and 15.
I'm a journalist.
She's a doctor.



Joe

49.2 Make questions with **who** or **what**.

- 1 Somebody hit me.
- 2 I hit somebody.
- 3 Somebody paid the bill.
- 4 Something happened.
- 5 Diane said something.
- 6 This book belongs to somebody.
- 7 Somebody lives in that house.
- 8 I fell over something.
- 9 Something fell off the shelf.
- 10 This word means something.
- 11 I borrowed the money from somebody.
- 12 I'm worried about something.

Who hit you?
Who did you hit?

Who
What

49.3 Put the words in brackets in the correct order. All the sentences are questions.

- 1 (when / was / built / this house) When was this house built?
- 2 (how / cheese / is / made)
- 3 (when / invented / the computer / was)
- 4 (why / Sue / working / isn't / today)
- 5 (what time / coming / your friends / are)
- 6 (why / was / cancelled / the trip)
- 7 (where / your mother / was / born)
- 8 (why / you / to the party / didn't / come)
- 9 (how / the accident / did / happen)
- 10 (why / this machine / doesn't / work)

49.4 Write negative questions from the words in brackets. In each situation you are surprised.

- 1 A: We won't see Lisa this evening.
B: Why not? (she / not / come / out with us?) Isn't she coming out with us?
- 2 A: I hope we don't meet Luke tonight.
B: Why? (you / not / like / him?)
- 3 A: Don't go and see that film.
B: Why not? (it / not / good?)
- 4 A: I'll have to borrow some money.
B: Why? (you / not / have / any?)